both sides would strictly honour the talks which were held between the Corps Commanders, which would involve the Chinese having to dismantle those structures. Later in the day, when the Indian troops visited PP14 to check if the structures had been dismantled, they observed that, in fact they hadn't. The Indian Commanding Officer ordered the Indian troops to dismantle the structure which was met with a small group of Chinese soldiers who engaged in a verbal spat. However in less than an hour, while this brawl went on, a larger group of Chinese soldiers arrived with iron rods, stones and sticks, outnumbering the Indian troops. The Indian Commanding Officer was hurt and fell into the freezing river, charging up our troops who wrangled the weapons from the Chinese. This fight seemed to be happening over a ledge, leading to several soldiers falling over into the icy-cold river. After learning about the brawl breaking, the Indian contingent too sent more soldiers armed with sticks. Both sides engaged in hand-to-hand combat, in which several Chinese soldiers were gravely injured. The main area of the fight was narrow and at one point the Indian troops had outnumbered the Chinese, compelling several Chinese soldiers to run off to the area of the Chinese build-up. A group of Indian soldiers who chased them, crossing the Line of Actual Control (LAC), were held captive and released four days after Major General-level talks were held on both sides the morning after. Rough estimates indicate that we lost about 20 men, whereas PLA lost about 43.[3] Several of them succumbed to their wounds unable to survive the freezing temperatures overnight.

One of the main reasons for the building up of tension along the region is considered to be a new road: the Darbuk–Shyok–DBO Road, which India had built along one of the most remote and vulnerable areas along the LAC in Ladakh. Ladakh is inhospitable in terms of its weather conditions, its highest valley being 9,800 feet above sea level and cold desert temperatures touching about -20C during winters. Due to the climatic hostility of the region, it has largely been a peaceful area of the LAC. However, India's effort to build a several hundred kilometres long road in 2019 activated at Daulat Beg Oldi (DBO), the world's highest landing ground, which would connect to a high-altitude forward air base was a cause for suspicion among the Chinese. The worry was that the road could significantly boost India's capacity to move men and material quickly in case of conflict. China had also extensively developed its infrastructure along the India–Tibet frontier. Even before the Galwan skirmish, scuffles had occurred between the two